

Documentary Evidence

Established clear documentary evidence of: (1) Submissions and recommendations sent to management with no response; (2) Requests for meetings or discussions about marketing strategy that were ignored; (3) Marketing materials produced that were not utilized or acknowledged; (4) Instances where marketing decisions were made without Ms. Lord's input or consultation. Note: this is not a complete list of instances but representative of work produced or requests made with little or no response or feedback.

1) Submissions and recommendations sent to management with no response

Date	Initiative	Parties	Response
5.12.2025	Expo Planning Strategy	Ford Susan	No Response
5.23.2025	Company Overview Flipbook	Thomas Ford	No Response
5.23.2025	Streams Pitch Deck	Alex	No Response
5.30.2025	Holiday Party Contract Review	Ford per Peter	No Response but Jennifer Liddy said Ford still wanted to do the party. Then, Cam said Ford told him to lead this.
6.13.2025	Website Proposal	Thomas Ford	No Response
6.20.2025	Social Media Branded Templates	Thomas Ford	No Response
6.26.2025	4 th of July SM Post	Thomas Ford	No Response
7.20.2025	Investor Brochure	Thomas Ford	No Response
7.20.2025	Binder Updates	Thomas	No Response
7.24.2025	Advertising Gvl Bus Magazine	Ford	No Response
7.24.2025	Employee Event Proposals	Thomas Ford	No Response
8.1.2025	Employee Teambuilding Proposals per Ford	Ford	No Response but gave this to Cameron
8.1.2025	Requested website authority	Thomas	Remains in Susan Roberts name
8.1.2025	Requested to manage all marketing functions	Thomas	Up to Ford, no response
8.8.2025	Website Saluda Page Build	Ford	No Response
8.15.2025	Crisis Communication Plan	Thomas Ford	No Response
8.15.2025	Newsletter Prototype	Thomas Ford	No Response

8.15.2025	Social Media HQ Move	Ford	Approved
8.18.2025	Social Media for Allison per Ford	Ford	Approved
8.28.2025	2025 Marketing Budget Info	Susan Roberts	No Response
8.29.2025	CA_Brand Playbook	Thomas Ford	No Response
9.4.2025	Project Updates	Adam	No Response
9.4.2025	Streams Brochure	Alex D	No Response
9.4.2025	Clemson Sponsorship	Ford	No Response
9.4.2025	2025/2026 Marketing Budget Proposal	Thomas Ford	No Response
9.6.2025	CH_Branding Guide	Thomas Ford	No Response
9.26.2025	CA_Marketing Deck	Josh Howard	Made requested edits
10.17.25	Requested and Sent Employee Self-Review after x2 requests from HR/ Thomas for form.	Thomas	No Response
11.3.2025	CH_Marketing Opportunities Assessment	Thomas Ford	No Response
11.3.2025	CH_Brand Positioning Strategy	Thomas Ford	No Response
11.07.26	Requested approval to post land acquisition of 335 acres on website	Thomas	No Response
11.4.2025	Social Media Craig	Ford	No Response
10.24.2025	Contender Homes Website DRAFT	Thomas Ford	No Response
10.24.2025	Contender Homes Blog (4) DRAFT	Thomas Ford	No Response
12.1.25	Contender America Homes - Requested direction on press announcement	Peter Reinert	No Response
12.12..25	Request for meeting for employee review.	Thomas	Scheduled meeting for Dec 15 with HR present (HR does not sit in on employee reviews).

12.16.25-1.05.26	Sent Brand Playbook, Creative Brief, logos, signature blocks, stationary designs, bios, business card designs, office interior branding wall concept, new website, etc.	Robert Kardos (I am told by Thomas Phillips to work directly with Robert Kardos on this new division).	Charlotte office admin responded to many of these submissions with a few changes. Although I am responsible for the branding and marketing of this new division, I have not received any information on launching this new company other than the price point of new homes. Everything I have provided is based on my research into the two residential markets. I have written all content for the website. I have not been included in any meetings either in Charlotte or in Greenville.
01.05.26	Request to join Chief Growth Officer, Thomas Phillips in his weekly meeting so that I could better anticipate marketing needs.	Thomas	Told meetings would not be productive from a marketing standpoint and to ask Allison Tucker for information if I needed it. She directed me to get info from Craig Yount. This info is on current project status but doesn't help me plan for strategic marketing need coming from projects I don't know about or that haven't yet been announced. I have no regularly scheduled meetings with my department.

Jan 11, 2026	Created a pitch deck for Topsy Taco to address restaurant issues. I had previously been asked to work with them on marketing. Sent to Thomas	Thomas	No response other than thank you. Not included in meetings with Topsy Taco or their ad agency, Ghost.
Jan 16, 2026	CH_Told not to go to Charlotte Mtg with Contender Homes even though I was going to be in Charlotte for a Dr appointment. This was a mtg with the new President of Contender Homes and I was responsible for all branding and website development.	Thomas	Response - negative
Feb 10, 2026	Question about Expo	Thomas Ford	Responded with answer
March 9, 2026	Real Estate Photography Ethics Corporate Policy - created policy and guidelines for all business entities to protect the company due to recent tightening of license law rules.	Thomas	No Response

- 2) Requests for meetings or discussions about marketing strategy that were ignored: Ford cancelled 4 meetings that Lord requested and scheduled (often at the last minute. He has promised comments on the proposed Contender America website but has not sent any response. She has repeatedly requested Thomas to set up a meeting to discuss issues with lack of authority over social media, public relations, website design and content – all of which Lord has decades of experience managing. Thomas has told Lord that he has no control over Susan Roberts (although she reports to him) as far as getting her to back away from marketing initiatives. Until recently, Roberts continued to order promotional items and was the co-owner of the website. When Lord has asked for Roberts help on information on previous budgets she either doesn't respond or gives Lord only partial information (see emails).

- 3) Marketing materials produced that were not utilized or acknowledged. These materials include marketing and branding proposals, budgets, ideas for branding Ford Elliott (separate from company), Contender Homes launch initiatives, investor relations digital media, pitch books, etc.

SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

Ms. Lord can provide the following documentary evidence to support this complaint:

- Email correspondence showing marketing recommendations and materials sent to management with no response.
- Documentation of marketing strategies and plans produced by Ms. Lord that were not implemented or acknowledged (marketing plans, marketing initiatives for 2025. Ms. Lord discussed needing additional information from leadership in order to prepare a marketing budget for 2026 but none was provided. Ms Lord prepared a proposed marketing budget for the launch of Contender America Homes but received no response or input from leadership.
- Examples of younger employees exercising greater autonomy and authority in similar or subordinate positions – Hayley Cape manages BIRE websites, agent onboarding, marketing materials, etc. – although her title was Customer Experience Coordinator. The current BIRE website says she is Senior Graphic Designer and Brand Manager. She reports to Christine Brodsky but makes all changes, additions, etc. on her own. Example: during a new agent onboarding, the agent asked to have her photo retaken (it was just taken that morning, but she didn't like it). Blackstream has an inhouse photographer so Lord asked if he was still around and could reshoot. Hayley said no. She refused to have him do the reshoot. Lord reported this to Christine Brodsky. Hayley went down to her office and complained. Hayley denied the reshoot. Hayley continually refused to assist Lord even when the marketing requests were from Ford. When Lord was told by Michael Mumma to take over some of Cape's work because she was "swamped", Lord immediately went to Cape and asked what she could help with. Cape refused to give Lord any of the tasks, stating "I'll let you know if I need your help."
- Social media management was taken away from Lord and given to Annette Wren supervised by Cape. Annette was hired to be an operations assistant, a role that does not require experience or expertise in social media (a marketing function).
- Lord was told that Alex Weldon, photographer was a direct report. She has an email from Cameron Aldridge, Director of HR that states that both Hayley and Alex will report to her. When Lord questioned this after realizing that Weldon's vacation was being approved by Christine Brodsky, he was removed from her oversight.
- Communications requiring CEO approval for routine marketing decisions that would typically fall within a Director's purview. She received an email from Susan Roberts when she asked her to post a 4th of July post as she would be out of the country. She was told that everything had to be approved by Ford. She sent the post to Ford and received no response. She recently sent a Welcome post to Ford for Craig Yount. It was approved by Craig and by his supervisor, Allison Tucker. No response from Ford. She repeatedly was in contact with Ford and Paul Luck, Division President of Raleigh (at

the time) to release a press release announcement about a major land acquisition. Paul continually called her stressing the importance of getting the release out. After a couple of weeks, it finally was approved to go out and within 48 hours it was announced that Paul Luck had quit.

- Performance evaluations or communications (if any) that contradict the pattern of marginalization. She has screenshots of responses that say “fantastic”, or “great” from Josh Howard, Ford Elliott, and Christine Brodsky over the past 3 years of employment. One telling issue is that she received no response to her 2024 Employee Self Review from Christine Brodsky or Michael Mumma, and had to request the form from Thomas Phillips, my supervisor for the 2025 review (the day it was due).
- **Any statements or communications that reference age, experience level, or retirement in connection with Ms. Lord's position.** Incidence #1: One day in January 2025, I was in my office and Damien Hall and Tyler James were standing at my door laughing. I asked what was so funny. They said that Hayley had just told them how old I was. I was extremely embarrassed. Incident #2: I was at Contender America at my desk. Adam Plous and Connor Parsons were discussing a hotel project outside of Charleston. Connor went on about how this employee was too old to be working there and she should just quit. I listened to them go back and forth demeaning the woman. I spoke up and said that that kind of talk was disrespectful to a woman and to anyone that was older. These are nice guys. I asked them what they thought was old. They said really she shouldn't be working there because she had to be at least 68 years old. I told them that in some instances, older people have to continue to work or may want to continue to work. After that time, I always felt like they assumed I was not capable of doing my job due to my age.